

THE FRAGRANCE WHEEL AND THE ART OF LAYERING

A Comprehensive Reference Guide

Built for Marty | Updated March 2026

This document covers the Michael Edwards Fragrance Wheel taxonomy, the science of how fragrance notes interact on skin and fabric, and a personalized layering matrix built around your collection of 18 fragrances.

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PART 1: THE FRAGRANCE WHEEL EXPLAINED

The fragrance wheel (also called the fragrance circle or olfactive wheel) is the industry standard classification system for organizing scents. The most comprehensive and widely accepted version was developed by Michael Edwards in 1983 and has been updated regularly since. Think of it as the color wheel of the fragrance world: just as colors that sit next to each other on the color wheel blend harmoniously, fragrance families that sit adjacent on the wheel tend to layer well together.

The Four Primary Families

The wheel is divided into four major quadrants, each containing subfamilies. Every fragrance you will ever encounter falls into one of these quadrants or bridges two of them.

1. FRESH

Subfamilies: Citrus, Water/Marine/Aquatic, Green, Fruity

Fresh fragrances are characterized by clean, bright, invigorating notes. Citrus subfamilies rely on bergamot, lemon, grapefruit, and mandarin. Water and marine subfamilies use synthetic molecules like calone to mimic ocean air. Green subfamilies lean on galbanum, violet leaf, and herbal notes. Fruity subfamilies pull from non-citrus fruits like peach, apple, and berries. These fragrances tend to be lighter in weight, project moderately, and work exceptionally well in warm and humid climates.

2. FLORAL

Subfamilies: Floral, Soft Floral, Floral Oriental

The largest family on the wheel. Pure floral subfamilies feature singular flower notes or bouquets (rose, jasmine, lily, tuberose). Soft floral subfamilies add powdery aldehydes and musk to create a more diffused, romantic effect. Floral oriental subfamilies bridge into the warm side of the wheel, incorporating spices and amber alongside florals. Rose is one of the most versatile and historically significant notes in all of perfumery, and it sits at the center of this quadrant.

3. ORIENTAL (also called AMBER)

Subfamilies: Soft Oriental, Oriental, Woody Oriental

Oriental fragrances are warm, rich, and sensual. They rely on amber, vanilla, incense (olibanum), resins like benzoin and labdanum, and exotic spices such as saffron, cardamom, and cinnamon. Soft orientals lean more toward powdery florals with a warm base. Classic orientals go full depth with balsamic and resinous notes. Woody orientals bridge toward the woody quadrant, incorporating sandalwood, oud, and patchouli. The word "oriental" in fragrance refers strictly to the olfactive profile. The industry is slowly transitioning to the term "amber" as an alternative.

4. WOODY

Subfamilies: Woods, Mossy Woods, Dry Woods, Aromatic

Woody fragrances center on cedar, sandalwood, vetiver, guaiac wood, patchouli, and oud (agarwood). Mossy woods incorporate oakmoss and other chypre (pronounced "sheep-ruh") elements, which is a

historical fragrance structure built on bergamot, oakmoss, and labdanum. Dry woods lean into smoky, leathery, and tobacco accords. Aromatic subfamilies incorporate herbs like lavender, rosemary, thyme, and sage, bridging the gap back toward the fresh quadrant to complete the circle.

The Key Principle: Adjacency

The fragrance wheel works in a circle. Fresh sits next to Floral, which sits next to Oriental, which sits next to Woody, which comes back around to Fresh. Families that are adjacent on the wheel share common characteristics and will layer harmoniously. **Families that are directly opposite on the wheel** (for example, pure citrus and heavy oriental) **create contrast**. Contrast is not inherently bad, but it requires more skill and intention to pull off well. The safest layering starts with adjacent families and subfamilies.

PART 2: UNDERSTANDING FRAGRANCE STRUCTURE

The Note Pyramid

Every fragrance is built in layers, organized into what the industry calls a note pyramid. Understanding this structure is essential for layering because you need to know which phase of each fragrance you are combining.

Top Notes (Head Notes) are what you smell in the first 15 to 30 minutes. These are the lightest, most volatile molecules: citrus, light fruits, herbs, and certain spices. They evaporate the fastest. When layering, you want the top notes of both fragrances to be compatible because this is the first impression you and everyone around you will experience.

Heart Notes (Middle Notes) emerge after the top notes fade, typically 30 minutes to two hours in. This is the core identity of the fragrance: florals, spices, and richer fruit accords. Heart notes are where layering combinations truly reveal themselves. If the hearts of two fragrances clash, the combination will feel dissonant for the majority of the wear time.

Base Notes are the foundation that lasts the longest, sometimes 12 or more hours. These are the heaviest molecules: woods, resins, musks, amber, vanilla, oud. Base notes anchor the entire composition and provide the "sillage" or scent trail. When layering, shared or complementary base notes are what make two fragrances feel like they belong together rather than competing.

Concentration and Its Role in Layering

The concentration of a fragrance (the percentage of perfume oil dissolved in alcohol) directly affects how it layers. Higher concentrations are denser, project differently, and dry down more slowly.

Concentration	Oil %	Longevity	Layering Behavior
Eau de Cologne	2-4%	2-3 hours	Light, fades quickly. Best as a top layer refresher.
Eau de Toilette (EDT)	5-15%	3-5 hours	Moderate density. Easy to layer but may get overpowered.
Eau de Parfum (EDP)	15-20%	5-8 hours	Ideal layering concentration. Balanced weight and longevity.
Parfum / Extrait	20-40%	8-24 hours	Dense and long lasting. Use fewer sprays. Apply first as base layer.
Absolu de Parfum	25-40%	10-24 hours	Ultra-dense. Treat like Extrait. Exceptional longevity.

Most of your collection sits in the EDP to Extrait range, with the Byredo Bal d'Afrique Absolu adding an Absolu de Parfum concentration to the mix. This means you are working with dense, long lasting fragrances. This is both an advantage and something to be mindful of. Dense fragrances project their heart and base notes more prominently, so layering conflicts in those zones will be more noticeable. The general rule: apply the heavier or denser fragrance first and the lighter one on top.

PART 3: THE SCIENCE OF LAYERING

Fragrance layering is the practice of wearing two or more fragrances simultaneously to create a scent that is uniquely yours. The goal is not to simply pile scents on top of each other. Instead, it is about combining fragrances whose molecular profiles complement and enhance one another.

The Five Rules of Layering

Rule 1: The Adjacency Principle. Combine fragrances from the same family or adjacent families on the wheel. A fresh citrus fragrance layers beautifully with a floral because they share that bright, light quality. An oriental layers naturally with a woody because they share warmth and depth. Jumping across the wheel (citrus with heavy oud, for example) creates tension. Tension can be interesting and intentional, but it requires a bridging note (a shared note present in both fragrances) to work.

Rule 2: The Shared Note Bridge. Look for at least one note that appears in both fragrances. This shared note acts as a bridge, telling your brain that these two scent profiles belong together. For example, if both fragrances contain rose, saffron, or musk, they will have a natural connection point even if the rest of their profiles differ.

Rule 3: Weight Matching. Combine fragrances of similar weight or intentionally contrast light on heavy. Two heavy orientals layered together can become cloying and suffocating. A fresh citrus on top of a deep oud, however, can brighten and lift the heavier fragrance beautifully. Think of it like food: you would not pair two rich, heavy dishes together, but a rich main with a bright, acidic side works perfectly.

Rule 4: Application Zones. You do not need to spray both fragrances on the same spot. In fact, it is often better not to. Apply the heavier, base-note-driven fragrance to your torso and clothes (where body heat slowly releases the scent). Apply the lighter, top-note-driven fragrance to pulse points like wrists and neck (where heat projects the brighter notes outward). As you move through the day, the lighter top notes fade first, gradually revealing more of the deeper base layer underneath. This creates a scent story that evolves throughout the day.

Rule 5: Restraint. Less is more. When layering, reduce the number of sprays from each fragrance. If you normally use four sprays of a single fragrance, use two of each when layering. Your total spray count should be the same or slightly less than what you would use for a single fragrance. This is especially important with your collection because many of your fragrances (Oud Maracuja, Blonde Amber, Oud Satin Mood Extrait, Baccarat Rouge Extrait, Bal d'Afrique Absolu) are extremely potent.

PART 4: YOUR COLLECTION MAPPED ON THE WHEEL

Below is every fragrance in your collection, its primary wheel family, key notes, and its weight classification (light, medium, heavy). The weight classification is important for layering: it tells you which fragrance should go on first (heavier) and which goes on top (lighter).

Fragrance	Family	Key Notes	Conc.	Weight
Symphony Louis Vuitton	FRESH Citrus	Grapefruit, Bergamot, Ginger, Orange, Musk	Extrait	Light
Torino 21 Xerjoff	FRESH Aromatic Green	Mint, Lemon, Basil, Thyme, Jasmine, Rosemary, Lavender, Musk	EDP	Light
Millesime Imperial Creed	FRESH Citrus Marine	Bergamot, Sea Salt, Lemon, Iris, Marine Notes, Musk, Sandalwood, Cedar	EDP	Light
Young Rose Byredo	FLORAL Floral Woody Musk	Sichuan Pepper, Ambrette, Damascena Rose, Iris, Musk, Ambroxan	EDP	Light- Medium
L'Homme a la Rose MFK	FLORAL Floral Woody Musk	Grapefruit, Damascena Rose, Sage, Amberwood	EDP	Light- Medium
Clive Christian E Cashmere Musk	FLORAL Soft Floral Woody	Bergamot, Pink Pepper, Ginger, Jasmine, Cashmeran, Guaiac Wood, Ambroxan, Musk	Parfum	Light- Medium
Good Morning Midnight Bottega Veneta	FLORAL Floral Oriental	Thai Oud, Rose, Wild Strawberry, Sandalwood	Parfum	Medium
Les Sables Roses Louis Vuitton	FLORAL Floral Oriental	Bulgarian Rose, Centifolia Rose, Black Pepper, Saffron, Oud, Ambergris	EDP	Medium- Heavy
Hibiscus Mahajad Maison Crivelli	FLORAL Floral Oriental	Hibiscus, Rose, Spearmint, Cinnamon, Leather, Vanilla, Ambrette Musk	Extrait	Medium- Heavy
Bal d'Afrique Absolu Byredo	ORIENTAL Floral Woody Musk (Gourmand)	Blackcurrant, Bergamot, Lemon, Praline, Musk, Violet, Black Amber, Cedar, Vetiver	Absolu de Parfum	Medium- Heavy
The One EDP Dolce & Gabbana	ORIENTAL Spicy Oriental	Bergamot, Coriander, Basil, Cardamom, Ginger, Cedar, Ambergris, Tobacco	EDP	Medium
Greenwich Village Bond No 9	ORIENTAL Oriental Floral	Cassis, Lychee, Mandarin, Peony, Jasmine, Ambroxan, Vanilla, Praline, Oakmoss	EDP	Medium
Lafayette Street Bond No 9	WOODY Oriental Fougere	Bergamot, Coriander, Apple, Ambroxan, Vanilla, Tonka, Dry Wood, Ambergris	EDP	Medium
Oud Ispahan Dior	ORIENTAL Floral Oriental	Labdanum, Rose, Patchouli, Saffron, Oud, Sandalwood, Cedar	EDP	Heavy
Baccarat Rouge 540 Extrait MFK	ORIENTAL Amber	Saffron, Jasmine, Amberwood, Ambergris, Cedar, Fir Resin, Ambroxan	Extrait	Medium- Heavy
Oud Satin Mood Extrait MFK	ORIENTAL Oriental Woody	Bulgarian Rose, Violet, Oud, Vanilla, Benzoin	Extrait	Heavy

Oud Maracuja Maison Crivelli	ORIENTAL Woody Oriental	Passionfruit, Rose, Saffron, Oud, Patchouli, Benzoin, Leather, Vanilla	Extrait	Heavy
Blonde Amber Clive Christian	ORIENTAL Amber	Rum, Olibanum, Bitter Orange, Ginger, Tobacco, Saffron, Tonka, Vanilla, Myrrh, Patchouli	Parfum	Heavy

PART 5: THE LAYERING COMPATIBILITY MATRIX

Rather than a full 18x18 grid (which would be unreadable), this section organizes your fragrances into layering tiers based on what they bring to a combination.

Your Collection by Role

BRIGHTENERS (Light, top-layer fragrances that lift heavier bases):

Symphony, Torino 21, Millesime Imperial, Young Rose, L'Homme a la Rose, Clive Christian E
Cashmere Musk

CORES (Medium-weight fragrances that can serve as either the base or top layer):

Good Morning Midnight, The One EDP, Greenwich Village, Lafayette Street, Baccarat Rouge 540
Extrait, Bal d'Afrique Absolu

ANCHORS (Heavy, base-layer fragrances that provide depth and longevity):

Oud Satin Mood Extrait, Oud Ispahan, Oud Maracuja, Blonde Amber, Les Sables Roses, Hibiscus
Mahajad

The simplest layering formula is: pick one Brightener and one Anchor, OR pick one Brightener and one Core, OR pick one Core and one Anchor. Combining two Anchors is possible but requires restraint on spray count (one to two sprays each, maximum).

Where the new Byredo additions fit: Young Rose slots into the Brightener tier alongside L'Homme a la Rose. They share a similar Floral Woody Musk classification, but Young Rose leans spicier (Sichuan pepper) where L'Homme a la Rose leans citrus-green (grapefruit, sage). They are not interchangeable but occupy similar weight. Bal d'Afrique Absolu lands as a Core. Its gourmand praline heart and black amber-vetiver base give it more density than a typical Byredo, but its bright bergamot-blackcurrant opening keeps it from Anchor territory. Think of it as your warmest Core, bridging toward the Anchors.

PART 6: RECOMMENDED LAYERING COMBINATIONS

These are specific combinations from your collection, organized by use case. Each one includes the bridge note (the shared note that holds the combination together), the recommended application strategy, and the vibe it creates.

The Signature

Pair: Symphony (top) + Les Sables Roses (base)

Bridge Note: Grapefruit/citrus brightness in Symphony lifts the rose of Les Sables Roses

Application: Les Sables Roses on chest and clothes, Symphony on neck and wrists

Vibe: Bright, clean rose with depth. Daytime elegance with substance. The citrus opens the conversation and the rose-oud takes over as the hours pass.

Best Season: Year-round, especially spring and fall

The Power Move

Pair: Baccarat Rouge 540 Extrait (base) + L'Homme a la Rose (top)

Bridge Note: Amberwood and ambroxan create a shared warmth. The grapefruit in L'Homme a la Rose brightens the amber density of BR540.

Application: BR540 Extrait on torso (one to two sprays only), L'Homme a la Rose on pulse points

Vibe: The ethereal sweetness of BR540 grounded by a masculine fresh rose. This combination has serious compliment-pulling potential.

Best Season: Fall, winter, evening events

The Oud Rose Experience

Pair: Oud Satin Mood Extrait (base) + Good Morning Midnight (top)

Bridge Note: Rose and oud present in both. The Thai oud and wild strawberry in Good Morning Midnight add a lighter, fruitier dimension to OSM's denser rose-oud.

Application: Oud Satin Mood Extrait on clothes, Good Morning Midnight on skin

Vibe: Layered oud-rose from two different perspectives. Rich and enveloping with a slightly playful top. Evening, date night, special occasions.

Best Season: Fall, winter

The Fresh Professional

Pair: Millesime Imperial (top) + Lafayette Street (base)

Bridge Note: Bergamot and ambergris/ambroxan are present in both. The marine iris of Millesime Imperial adds a clean brightness to Lafayette's woody amber.

Application: Lafayette Street on torso, Millesime Imperial on neck and wrists

Vibe: Clean, polished, office-appropriate. Projects confidence without announcing itself. This is the combination for high-stakes meetings.

Best Season: Spring, summer, professional settings year-round

The Warm Night

Pair: Blonde Amber (base) + The One EDP (top)

Bridge Note: Shared tobacco, spice, and amber notes. The One's bergamot and cedar add a fresher, more approachable entry point to Blonde Amber's depth.

Application: Blonde Amber on chest and clothes (one to two sprays), The One on pulse points

Vibe: Warm, spiced, inviting. Like a whiskey by a fireplace. Evening dinners, lounge settings.

Best Season: Fall, winter

The Exotic Fruit

Pair: Oud Maracuja (base) + Symphony (top)

Bridge Note: The tropical fruit of Oud Maracuja's passionfruit and the citrus brightness of Symphony share a fruity DNA. The grapefruit in Symphony echoes the bright opening of Oud Maracuja while lifting its leathery oud base.

Application: Oud Maracuja on clothes (one spray), Symphony on skin

Vibe: Bright tropical fruit over dark leathery oud. Unexpected and memorable. Turns heads.

Best Season: Fall transitions, mild weather evenings

The Sweet Sophisticate

Pair: Greenwich Village (base) + Hibiscus Mahajad (top)

Bridge Note: Both share a fruity-floral-vanilla structure. The lychee and cassis of Greenwich Village complement the hibiscus and rose of Hibiscus Mahajad. Vanilla appears in both bases.

Application: Greenwich Village on torso, Hibiscus Mahajad on pulse points

Vibe: Lush, fruity, and glamorous. Statement-making without being aggressive. Art events, dinners, cultural evenings.

Best Season: Spring, early fall

The Italian Morning

Pair: Torino 21 (top) + Clive Christian E Cashmere Musk (base)

Bridge Note: Both share fresh green-herbal qualities. Musk appears in both bases. The mint and herbs of Torino 21 float over the soft cashmeran warmth of E Cashmere Musk.

Application: E Cashmere Musk on torso, Torino 21 on pulse points

Vibe: Clean, airy, approachable. Like stepping out of a luxury hotel in Turin. Perfect daily wear.

Best Season: Spring, summer, casual daytime

The Desert Rose

Pair: Oud Ispahan (base) + Les Sables Roses (mid) or L'Homme a la Rose (top)

Bridge Note: Rose, saffron, and oud are shared between Oud Ispahan and Les Sables Roses. If using L'Homme a la Rose instead, the shared bridge is rose with a citrus lift.

Application: Oud Ispahan on clothes, the second fragrance on skin pulse points

Vibe: Deep, romantic, Middle Eastern-inspired opulence. This is for when you want to be remembered.

Best Season: Fall, winter, formal evening

The Everyday Flex

Pair: Lafayette Street (base) + Torino 21 (top)

Bridge Note: Both share bergamot and green herbal notes. The ambroxan in Lafayette Street gives longevity while Torino 21's mint and lemon keep it fresh.

Application: Lafayette Street on torso, Torino 21 on neck

Vibe: Effortlessly cool. The kind of smell that makes people lean in and ask what you are wearing without being overwhelming.

Best Season: Spring, summer, casual year-round

The Velvet Rebel

Pair: Bal d'Afrique Absolu (base) + Young Rose (top)

Bridge Note: Both are Byredo compositions by Jerome Epinette. Shared musk and violet notes create a natural bridge. The Sichuan pepper in Young Rose cuts through the praline sweetness of Bal d'Afrique Absolu, preventing it from becoming cloying.

Application: Bal d'Afrique Absolu on chest and clothes (one to two sprays), Young Rose on pulse points

Vibe: Spicy-fresh rose over gourmand amber-praline. Modern, unexpected, gender-fluid. The kind of scent that reads as effortlessly cool and culturally literate.

Best Season: Spring, fall, evening social events

The Black Tie

Pair: Baccarat Rouge 540 Extrait (base) + Bal d'Afrique Absolu (top)

Bridge Note: Both share amber-driven warmth and similar sweetness profiles. The praline in BdA Absolu echoes the amberwood sweetness of BR540, while the blackcurrant and bergamot opening add dimension that BR540 lacks on its own.

Application: BR540 Extrait on torso (one spray), Bal d'Afrique Absolu on neck and wrists (one spray)

Vibe: A gourmand amber powerhouse with more complexity than either fragrance alone. Formal events, gallery openings, statement nights.

Best Season: Fall, winter, formal evening

The Rose Garden

Pair: Young Rose (top) + Les Sables Roses (base)

Bridge Note: Damascena rose is the heart of both fragrances. Young Rose brings a spicy, airy interpretation while Les Sables Roses delivers the deeper oud-saffron-rose. Together they create a multi-dimensional rose experience.

Application: Les Sables Roses on clothes, Young Rose on skin

Vibe: Rose told from two altitudes: one bright and dewy at the top, the other deep and resinous underneath. Romantic without being predictable.

Best Season: Year-round, especially spring and fall transitions

PART 7: APPLICATION STRATEGY

Skin vs. Clothes: The Full Picture

On Skin: Fragrance interacts with your body chemistry, sebum (the oils your skin naturally produces), and body heat. This interaction is what makes a fragrance smell uniquely yours versus how it smells on a paper strip or on someone else. Pulse points (wrists, neck, behind ears, inside elbows) generate heat that projects the fragrance outward. On warm skin, fragrances will project more aggressively in the first hour, so err toward fewer sprays.

On Clothes: Fabric holds fragrance molecules for much longer because there is no body chemistry to break them down. Cotton, linen, wool, silk, and cashmere hold scent the longest. Synthetic fabrics hold less. Clothes give you longevity and a consistent scent trail (sillage) that does not shift with body chemistry. The downside is that heavy fragrances (oud, amber, tobacco) can stain light-colored fabrics over time, and the scent will not evolve the same way it does on skin.

The Combined Approach (Recommended): When layering, apply the heavier anchor fragrance to your clothes (chest area, inside of jacket collar) and the lighter brightener fragrance to your skin pulse points. This way your body heat projects the lighter notes while the clothes hold and slowly release the deeper base. As the day progresses, the skin fragrance fades first, leaving the deeper clothes layer as your lasting signature.

Spray Count Guidelines for Layering

Scenario	Base Fragrance	Top Fragrance	Total
Casual / Office	1-2 sprays on clothes	1-2 sprays on skin	2-4 total
Evening / Going Out	2-3 sprays on clothes	1-2 sprays on skin	3-5 total
Atlanta Summer Humidity	1 spray on clothes	1 spray on skin	2 total
Cool / Dry Climate	2-3 sprays on clothes	2 sprays on skin	4-5 total

PART 8: CLIMATE CONSIDERATIONS

Atlanta Humidity Factor

Atlanta's subtropical humidity amplifies fragrance projection significantly. Heat and moisture cause fragrance molecules to volatilize (evaporate off the skin) faster, which means stronger projection in the first few hours but potentially shorter longevity. High humidity also increases the perception of sweetness and heaviness. A fragrance that feels balanced in a dry, cool environment can become cloying and overpowering in Atlanta's July heat.

Summer Strategy (May through September): Lean heavily on your Brighteners. Symphony, Torino 21, Millesime Imperial, Young Rose, L'Homme a la Rose, and Clive Christian E Cashmere Musk are your primary rotation. Young Rose's spicy-fresh profile makes it a particularly strong summer option, as the Sichuan pepper reads as energizing rather than heavy in warm air. If you layer during summer, pair only a Brightener with a Core, never two Anchors. Reduce spray count by 30 to 50 percent compared to cooler months. Note: Bal d'Afrique Absolu's praline sweetness can become overwhelming in Atlanta humidity. Save it for air-conditioned evenings during summer months.

Winter Strategy (November through February): Your Anchors come into full play. Oud Satin Mood Extrait, Blonde Amber, Oud Ispahan, and Oud Maracuja are designed for cooler, drier air where the heavier molecules linger close to the body and release slowly with body heat. Bal d'Afrique Absolu performs at its best in winter, where the praline-amber warmth reads as inviting rather than cloying. Layering two Anchors (like Oud Ispahan plus Oud Satin Mood Extrait) is acceptable in winter as long as you keep total spray count low.

Transition Seasons (March-April, October): These are the layering sweet spot. The moderate temperatures let you combine a Brightener with an Anchor without the humidity amplifying everything. This is when combinations like Symphony plus Les Sables Roses, L'Homme a la Rose plus Baccarat Rouge Extrait, or Young Rose plus Bal d'Afrique Absolu really shine.

Travel and Dry Climates: In drier environments (the Southwest, the Mediterranean, the Middle East), fragrances sit closer to the skin and project less. You can afford to increase spray count by one to two sprays and lean more into your Anchors year-round. Dry heat is where heavy oud and amber fragrances perform at their absolute best.

COMBINATIONS TO AVOID

Oud Maracuja + Greenwich Village: The tropical passionfruit-leather of Oud Maracuja clashes with the lychee-praline sweetness of Greenwich Village. Both are pushing fruity-sweet in different directions with no bridge note to connect them.

Torino 21 + Oud Satin Mood Extrait: The herbal mint of Torino 21 and the dense rose-vanilla-oud of Oud Satin Mood exist in completely different olfactive worlds. There is no bridge note, and the weight mismatch is extreme.

Blonde Amber + Hibiscus Mahajad: Both are heavy and complex with enormous note pyramids. Layering them creates olfactive noise rather than harmony. Each fragrance has so many moving parts that combining them muddies both compositions.

Symphony + Oud Ispahan: Pure bright citrus directly into heavy dark oud with no bridging notes. This is the opposite-side-of-the-wheel problem. Les Sables Roses bridges this gap because it has both rose (connecting to Oud Ispahan) and a lighter overall structure (connecting to Symphony), but going directly from Symphony to Oud Ispahan skips the bridge.

Bal d'Afrique Absolu + Oud Maracuja: Both push toward dense, sweet gourmand territory but from completely different directions. The praline-amber of BdA Absolu and the passionfruit-leather-oud of Oud Maracuja compete for attention with no shared bridge note to unify them. The result is olfactive confusion.

Bal d'Afrique Absolu + Greenwich Village: Two praline-forward compositions layered together will collapse into a one-dimensional sweetness. The blackcurrant of BdA Absolu and the lychee-cassis of Greenwich Village are too similar in their fruity-sweet register to create contrast or interest.

This document is a living reference. As you add fragrances to your collection, each new acquisition can be mapped onto the wheel, assigned a role (Brightener, Core, or Anchor), and integrated into the layering matrix.